Shane Warne

Warnie always looked like he was enjoying himself, both on and off the pitch – almost as much as me, I suspect. During Warnie's international career, he enjoyed his beer and cigarettes, but he was always still able to go out there and bowl the way he did. He'd chirp batters left, right and centre and get in your face virtually every game you played, but he was also really funny sometimes. It just looked like he was having a great time.

I used to enjoy Warnie's chirps more than anyone else's. He was really clever – he knew just what to say at just the right time. I never felt like he was really having a go at anyone personally, but sometimes he'd say something so bladdy funny that I'd end up laughing out loud. Warnie's got a mouth on him and he can talk lots of shit, but he also comes out with a few gems now and again. I used to try hard to remember what Warnie said to me so I could tell people, but I dunno, his words just never stuck.

Warnie is probably the best spinner the world has ever seen – the fact that he has taken wickets all over the world and that his home-and-away record is almost equally good backs that up.

As a batsman, I was never that confident against him. He was just a different bowler. Unlike, say, a left-arm off-spinner, Warnie used to get the ball to drift in to you. Using his wrist and fingers, he could put so many revs on the ball that it would not only dip down very late, but move towards you like an in-swinger. So, if the ball started on off- or middle-stump, the in-drift would cause it to eventually pitch outside leg. That made it really difficult to use your feet, as you couldn't really predict where the ball would land.

Basically you had to play him like an in-swinger – I'd keep my head still for as long as possible and, if the delivery was full enough and pitching outside leg stump, I'd either sweep him or just defend. I'd wait for anything short and then cut him. But I never felt comfortable using my feet against Warnie. Even with the 100 I got against the Aussies during the 1999 World Cup at Headingly, I hardly ever used my feet. Mostly I just used to sweep him. Without that drift, he would still have been a good bowler, but I don't think he would've been quite so special.

After that game at Headingly, Warnie was the first guy to come and have a drink with me – he's a brilliant bowler on the field and a great bloke off it. When I saw him again at the start of the 2010 IPL season in Mumbai, I said,